WellPeps



THE SMART PATIENT'S GUIDE TO

HAIR RESTORATION

Understanding hair loss, today's treatment options, and what to realistically expect

PERSONALIZED WELLNESS. SIMPLIFIED.

BEFORE YOU START

Understand What You're Treating

Hair loss is common—but understanding why it's happening can make a meaningful difference in choosing what to do next.

For some people, hair loss develops gradually over many years. For others, increased shedding seems to appear suddenly. Some first notice a receding hairline. Others see a widening part, thinning crown, smaller ponytail, bald spot, or more hair than usual in the shower.

Genetics can play an important role, but hair loss can also be associated with hormonal changes, illness, medications, nutritional deficiencies, significant stress, autoimmune conditions and scalp disorders.

That's why the first step shouldn't simply be choosing a hair-growth product.

It should be understanding what you're treating.



SMART PATIENT INSIGHT

Different types of hair loss can require different approaches. Understand the likely cause before choosing a treatment.

THE WELLPEPS APPROACH

Treatment begins with your health information and hair-loss history. A licensed healthcare provider determines whether treatment may be appropriate.

UNDERSTAND HAIR LOSS

Why Does Hair Loss Happen?

Hair loss isn't one condition. Different biological and medical factors can affect how hair grows, sheds and changes over time.



PATTERN HAIR LOSS

Androgenetic alopecia—often called male or female pattern hair loss—is the most common form of hereditary hair loss. Genetics and hormone activity can cause susceptible follicles to gradually become smaller, producing progressively thinner and shorter hairs.

EXCESSIVE SHEDDING

Telogen effluvium can cause increased shedding following illness, surgery, childbirth, significant weight change, severe stress or other physical stressors.

OTHER CAUSES

Autoimmune conditions such as alopecia areata can cause hair loss. Thyroid disorders, nutritional deficiencies, certain medications, scalp conditions and traction from hairstyles are among other potential contributors.

The appropriate approach depends on what is causing the hair loss.

SMART PATIENT QUESTION

Could something other than hereditary pattern hair loss be contributing to my symptoms?

THE WELLPEPS APPROACH

When a patient's history suggests another potential cause, additional medical evaluation or testing may be appropriate.

RECOGNIZE THE PATTERN

Hair Loss Doesn’t Look the Same for Everyone

Where and how hair changes can offer clues to the type of hair loss.

Men

RECEDING HAIRLINE

Hair gradually recedes around the temples and frontal hairline.

THINNING CROWN

Density decreases around the crown or top of the scalp.

PROGRESSIVE PATTERN LOSS

Hairline recession and crown thinning can become more extensive over time.

Women

WIDENING PART

The center part can gradually become wider and more visible.

REDUCED DENSITY

Hair may feel less full or a ponytail may become noticeably smaller.

DIFFUSE THINNING

Thinning often occurs across the top of the scalp rather than forming a clearly defined bald area.

Other patterns

Sudden shedding, isolated bald patches, rapid changes, scalp inflammation or scarring can suggest a different cause and may warrant in-person dermatologic evaluation.



SMART PATIENT INSIGHT

Don’t assume every receding hairline, widening part or episode of shedding has the same cause.

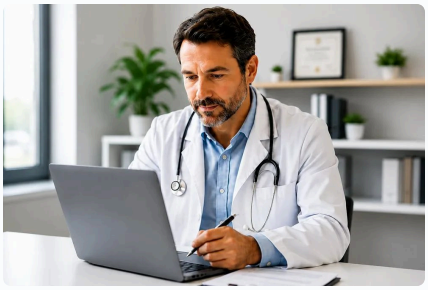
THE WELLPEPS APPROACH

A patient’s pattern, timing and progression of hair loss are important parts of determining an appropriate next step.

START WITH THE MEDICAL QUESTION

What Type of Hair Loss Do You Have?

Hair-loss treatment should begin with a medical question: What appears to be causing the hair loss in this particular patient?



A treatment that's commonly used for hereditary pattern hair loss may not address hair loss caused by an autoimmune disorder, nutritional deficiency, medication, illness or scalp condition.

A healthcare provider may consider factors such as:

PATTERN
Where is thinning occurring?

TIMING
Was the change gradual or sudden?

MEDICATIONS
Could a medication or supplement be involved?

HEALTH HISTORY
Are there medical conditions that could contribute?

OTHER SYMPTOMS
Are there scalp changes or other health concerns?

Depending on the circumstances, laboratory testing or evaluation by a dermatologist or another healthcare professional may be appropriate.

SMART PATIENT QUESTION

Has my hair loss actually been evaluated before treatment is prescribed?

THE WELLPEPS APPROACH

Submitting a health assessment should not guarantee a prescription. A licensed healthcare provider determines whether treatment is appropriate.

KNOW YOUR OPTIONS

Today's Common Hair-Loss Medications

Spend a few minutes researching hair restoration and you'll encounter dozens of products and ingredients. They don't all work the same way—or have the same level of evidence.

MINOXIDIL

Works through mechanisms associated with hair growth. FDA-approved topical formulations are available for male and female pattern hair loss.

FINASTERIDE

Reduces formation of DHT, a hormone involved in follicle miniaturization in male pattern hair loss. Oral finasteride 1 mg is FDA-approved for male pattern hair loss.

OTHER PRESCRIPTION OPTIONS

Depending on the patient, medical providers may consider other medications such as oral minoxidil, spironolactone or dutasteride.

Some uses are off-label, meaning the medication is FDA-approved for another indication but not specifically approved for that hair-loss use.

There is no universally correct treatment for every patient. The cause and pattern of hair loss, health history, current medications, potential risks and treatment preferences can all affect the decision.



SMART PATIENT QUESTION

Why is this particular treatment being recommended for my type of hair loss?

THE WELLPEPS APPROACH

Treatment options are selected through licensed-provider review rather than a one-size-fits-all approach.

UNDERSTAND THE TREATMENT

Finasteride and the Role of DHT

Finasteride targets one pathway behind male pattern hair loss.

An enzyme called 5-alpha-reductase converts testosterone into dihydrotestosterone, or DHT. In genetically susceptible men, DHT contributes to the gradual miniaturization of hair follicles.

Finasteride inhibits 5-alpha-reductase and reduces DHT levels.

ORAL FINASTERIDE

Finasteride 1 mg is FDA-approved for male pattern hair loss in men. It is generally taken once daily. Treatment takes time. If finasteride is effective, continued treatment is generally necessary to maintain the benefit.

TOPICAL FINASTERIDE

Finasteride can also be prescribed in compounded topical formulations, sometimes in combination with minoxidil.

▲ RED FLAG

No FDA-approved topical finasteride

There is currently no FDA-approved topical finasteride formulation in the United States. FDA also cautions that topical finasteride can be absorbed systemically and has reported adverse events associated with compounded topical products.



SMART PATIENT QUESTION

Do I understand the potential benefits, risks and approval status of the finasteride formulation being recommended?

THE WELLPEPS APPROACH

Provider-guided care considers potential risks as well as treatment goals.

UNDERSTAND THE TREATMENT

Minoxidil: A Different Approach

Minoxidil works differently from finasteride and has a long history in hair-loss treatment.



TOPICAL MINOXIDIL

FDA-approved topical minoxidil products are available for pattern hair loss in men and women. Topical minoxidil is applied directly to the scalp. Depending on the product, it may be used once or twice daily. Results aren't immediate. Consistent use for several months may be necessary before response can be meaningfully evaluated. Temporary increased shedding can occur after treatment begins, and scalp irritation is another possible side effect.

ORAL MINOXIDIL

Minoxidil was originally developed as an oral medication for high blood pressure. Healthcare providers also sometimes prescribe low-dose oral minoxidil off-label for hair loss. Because oral medication circulates throughout the body, medical history, current medications and potential systemic effects are important considerations.

SMART PATIENT QUESTION

If minoxidil is recommended, why is this route and formulation appropriate for me?

THE WELLPEPS APPROACH

Route of administration is part of the treatment decision—not simply a matter of convenience.

KNOW THE DIFFERENCES

Oral vs. Topical: What Actually Changes?

The same treatment goal can sometimes be approached through very different delivery methods.

TOPICAL

- Applied directly to the scalp
- Usually part of a regular application routine
- Can cause scalp irritation or residue
- Generally lower systemic exposure, depending on the medication
- May affect some hair-care routines

ORAL

- Taken by mouth
- Often simple to incorporate into a daily routine
- Produces systemic medication exposure
- May have systemic side effects or monitoring considerations
- Avoids topical residue or scalp application

Neither route is automatically “better.”

The type of hair loss, medication, medical history, potential risks, previous treatment experience and patient preferences can all affect the provider’s recommendation.



SMART PATIENT QUESTION

What are the advantages and potential disadvantages of oral and topical treatment for me?

THE WELLPEPS APPROACH

A medical provider can consider both the treatment itself and the most appropriate way to deliver it.

PERSONALIZED TREATMENT OPTIONS

Why Might Medications Be Combined?

Different hair-loss medications can work through different biological pathways. For example:



FINASTERIDE

Addresses DHT activity involved in male pattern hair loss.

MINOXIDIL

Works through a different mechanism associated with hair growth.

TRETINOIN

May be included in certain compounded topical formulations.

A medical provider may sometimes consider a treatment containing more than one active ingredient based on the individual patient's needs and available treatment options.

But more ingredients don't automatically mean better treatment.

And FDA approval of an individual ingredient does not mean that every compounded combination containing that ingredient is FDA-approved. There are currently no FDA-approved topical finasteride products, including topical finasteride/minoxidil combinations.

SMART PATIENT QUESTION

Why are these particular medications being combined in my treatment?

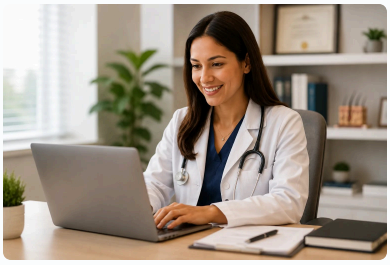
THE WELLPEPS APPROACH

Treatment should have a clinical rationale. The goal isn't the longest ingredient list—it's an appropriate plan for the individual patient.

KNOW YOUR OPTIONS

Dutasteride, Spironolactone and Other Treatments

Some patients may be considered for prescription medications beyond topical minoxidil and oral finasteride.



DUTASTERIDE

Like finasteride, dutasteride is a 5-alpha-reductase inhibitor that affects DHT production. Dutasteride is FDA-approved for benign prostatic hyperplasia—not hair loss. Hair-loss treatment with dutasteride in the United States is therefore off-label.

SPIRONOLACTONE

Spironolactone has anti-androgen activity and is sometimes prescribed for women with female pattern hair loss. Its use for hair loss is also off-label. Medical history, current medications and pregnancy considerations can be important when determining whether spironolactone is appropriate.

OTHER APPROACHES

Depending on the cause and severity of hair loss, dermatologists may also discuss procedures, devices or other treatment approaches.

SMART PATIENT INSIGHT

“Used for hair loss” and “FDA-approved for hair loss” don’t always mean the same thing.

THE WELLPEPS APPROACH

When an off-label treatment is considered, patients should understand what is being prescribed and why.

SET REALISTIC EXPECTATIONS

Hair Restoration Takes Time

Hair grows slowly. That's why hair-loss treatment usually can't be fairly evaluated after a few days or weeks.



STARTING TREATMENT

The first priority is consistency. Visible change may be limited early in treatment.

FIRST FEW MONTHS

Some treatments can be associated with temporary increased shedding after treatment begins.

3–6 MONTHS

Depending on the medication and individual response, changes may begin to become noticeable.

6–12 MONTHS

For many hair-loss treatments, this is a more meaningful period for evaluating response.

The exact timeline varies based on the medication, type and severity of hair loss, individual biology and treatment consistency. AAD advises that topical minoxidil may require about 6–12 months to determine how well it is working for an individual patient.

SMART PATIENT INSIGHT

Hair restoration is generally measured in months—not days or weeks.

THE WELLPEPS APPROACH

Responsible care means setting realistic expectations rather than promising an overnight transformation.

DEFINE SUCCESS REALISTICALLY

What Does a Good Result Actually Look Like?

Successful hair-loss treatment doesn't necessarily mean restoring every hair that has been lost.

Depending on the patient, type and stage of hair loss, and treatment, goals may include:

SLOWING ADDITIONAL LOSS

For progressive pattern hair loss, slowing further thinning can be an important objective.

MAINTAINING EXISTING HAIR

Preserving existing density can matter, particularly when treatment begins earlier.

IMPROVING DENSITY OR COVERAGE

Some patients may experience increased density or improved scalp coverage.

REGROWTH

Established treatments can produce regrowth in some patients, but the degree of response varies. Topical minoxidil, for example, cannot be expected to restore an entire head of hair.

No responsible program should guarantee complete restoration or a specific amount of regrowth.



SMART PATIENT QUESTION

What is a realistic treatment goal for my particular type and stage of hair loss?

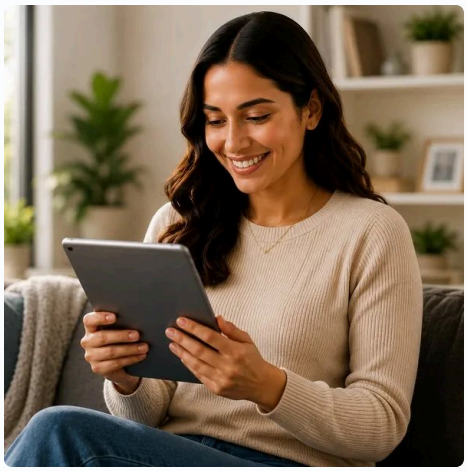
THE WELLPEPS APPROACH

Good treatment begins with realistic expectations and an understanding that individual responses vary.

THINK LONG TERM

Consistency Matters

One of the most important facts about hair-loss treatment is also one of the easiest to overlook: many treatments require continued use.



Pattern hair loss is generally progressive. Medication doesn't permanently remove the biological factors contributing to hereditary hair loss. For treatments such as finasteride and minoxidil, stopping treatment can result in loss of treatment benefit over time.

That makes consistency an important part of choosing a treatment.

Ask yourself

Can I realistically follow this routine?

Some patients may prefer applying a topical medication. Others may find an oral medication easier to use consistently. Convenience isn't the only consideration—but a treatment plan is more useful when a patient can realistically follow it.

SMART PATIENT INSIGHT

Hair-loss treatment is often an ongoing strategy, not a one-time fix.

THE WELLPEPS APPROACH

Treatment decisions can consider effectiveness, potential risks, individual preferences and the patient's ability to follow the treatment plan.

USE THE CHECKLIST

The Smart Patient's Hair Restoration Checklist ☑

Be informed. Ask questions. Understand the care behind the treatment.

01

Understand the cause

What type of hair loss do I appear to have?

02

Look beyond the hair

Could a health condition, medication, nutritional issue or another factor be contributing?

03

Understand the recommendation

Why is this particular medication or formulation being recommended for me?

04

Compare the routes

Would oral or topical treatment make more sense for my individual needs?

05

Know the risks

What potential side effects, contraindications or interactions should I understand?

06

Set a timeline

How long should I use treatment before evaluating my response?

07

Think long term

What happens if the treatment works and I later stop using it?

A BETTER APPROACH TO CARE

Why We Created WellPeps

Real Care. Not Just Medication.



WellPeps was founded by a physician and an experienced pharmacy owner who believed there should be a better way to bring together thoughtful medical care, quality prescription fulfillment and a more convenient patient experience.

That perspective shaped the WellPeps approach: personalized, provider-guided care designed around the patient—not simply the medication.

Personalized Provider-Guided Care

Treatment begins with your health information, medications, goals and individual circumstances.

Multiple Wellness Options

Different treatment options allow providers to consider what may be appropriate for different individuals.

More Than a Prescription

The WellPeps experience is designed around care—not simply delivering medication.

Quality Prescription Fulfillment

Prescriptions are fulfilled through U.S.-based pharmacy partners selected to support quality and reliable prescription fulfillment.

Ongoing Support

Your questions and treatment needs don't necessarily stop when treatment begins.

Straightforward Pricing

One monthly price: provider review, follow-up care, messaging, shipping and medication when prescribed.

Healthcare Without the Runaround

A simpler, more convenient way to access treatment—from assessment and medical review to prescription fulfillment and ongoing support.

More Than Hair Restoration

WellPeps offers a wide and expanding range of treatment programs for your wellness needs.

GET THE COMPREHENSIVE CARE YOU DESERVE



Ready to Explore Your Hair Restoration Options?

Begin with a private online health assessment. A licensed healthcare provider will review your health information and determine whether treatment is appropriate for you.

See If You Qualify

It only takes a few minutes.

Be informed.
Ask questions.
Become a Smart Patient
and get the comprehensive care you deserve.

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Personalized Wellness. Simplified.

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Educational information, not medical advice.

This guide is provided for general educational purposes only and does not constitute medical advice, diagnosis or treatment. Individual medical needs vary. Always discuss treatment decisions, medications, side effects and health concerns with an appropriately licensed healthcare professional.

Prescription treatment requires evaluation by a licensed healthcare provider and is not guaranteed. Individual experiences vary, and no specific treatment outcome is guaranteed.

Some medications discussed in this guide may be prescribed off-label, meaning an FDA-approved medication is prescribed for a use that has not been approved by FDA.

Some treatment options may involve compounded medications. Compounded medications are not FDA-approved finished drug products. FDA does not review compounded medications for safety, effectiveness or quality before marketing in the same manner as FDA-approved drugs.

A licensed healthcare provider determines whether a particular medication, formulation and treatment approach may be appropriate for an individual patient.

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The Smart Patient's Guide to Sexual Wellness Medications
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The Smart Patient's Guide Series



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Internal Medicine · Reviewed November 12, 2026